Recovering Margilal

After Makaram left, the same day near the afternoon prayer, a horseman named Yul-Chuq, Ali Dost Taghai's servant appeared at the foot of the valley with a message:[*]

> Although many great misdeeds have had their rise in me, yet, if you will do me the favor and kindness of coming to me, I hope to purge my offenses and remove my reproach, by giving you Margilal and by my future submission and single-minded service.

The coming of such news during such a time of despair and *whirl-of-mind,* was unexpected for Babur. Without wasting any time, hurriedly, Babur along with his pack twenty people rode straight to Margilal on the very evening. The place was around 145 miles from there. Without stopping and delaying anywhere, they kept riding throughout the night only to reach Tang-ab, a village inKhujand by the mid-day prayer on the next day. They decided to halt there. Horses were given some rest after a stressful journey and fed corn. And again, as night approached, they began to ride. Travelling through such region in night had its own problems such as the attack by beasts. In order to avoid such unwanted adventures, they ensured that the drums were beaten loudly. The next dawn came after the dusk, and the night and the dawn. They were just six miles away from the destination, Margilal.

Wais Beg came to meet Babur and narrated all he could about Ali Dost's evil plans. Babur wouldn't trust him, but having ridden for three nights and two days, he had no desire whatsoever to return. He relied on Allah's will and thought that if he has been made to ride till here then only good would be waiting for him ahead.

At the time of *Sunnat* prayer, they reached Fort Margilal. Ali Dost Taghai spelled his terms from behind the closed gate and when granted, he opened it. He showered obeisance on Babur between the (two) gates. After seeing him, Babur dismounted at a suitable house in the walled town.

Auzun Hasan and Tambal had been tyrannical and opressed Margilal's people. All the clans of the country had been asking for Babur for long, and they were delighted on seeing him. Having heard them for two–three days, Babur made the next move. He had already called on Qasim Beg along with a hundred men from Pashagharis. They along with the new retainers of Margilal, Ali Dost's followers, and other loyal men of Babur were sent to bring over, by force or fair words, such mountain people of the south of